U. S. DEPARTMENT OF LABOR

JAMES J. DAVIS, Secretary

CHILDREN'S BUREAU

FOURTEENTH ANNUAL REPORT OF THE CHIEF OF THE CHILDREN'S BUREAU TO THE SECRETARY OF LABOR

FISCAL YEAR
ENDED JUNE 30
1926

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FOURTEENTH ANNUAL REPORT

OF THE

CHIEF OF THE CHILDREN'S BUREAU

FOR THE FISCAL YEAR ENDED JUNE 30, 1926

UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF LABOR,
CHILDREN'S BUREAU,
Washington, September 15, 1926.

HON. JAMES J. DAVIS,
Secretary of Labor.

SIR: I have the honor to transmit herewith the fourteenth annual report of the Children's Bureau, for the fiscal year July 1, 1925, to June 30, 1926.

THE MATERNITY AND INFANCY ACT

Administration.

During the past year 43 States and Hawaii have cooperated with the Children's Bureau under the provisions of the maternity and infancy act in the promotion of the health of mothers and infants.

The following table gives the amounts available and the total amounts accepted by the States from the appropriations for the fiscal years 1922, 1923, 1924, and 1925, and the amounts accepted up to June 30, 1926, from the appropriations for the fiscal year 1926:

Amounts available[1] *to States from Federal maternity and infancy funds and amounts accepted*[2]

[Statement as of June 30, 1926]

States	Maximum amounts available from 1922 appropriation[3]	Amounts accepted by States from 1922 appropriation	Maximum amounts available from 1923 and 1924 appropriations	Amounts accepted by States from—		Maximum amounts available from 1925 and 1926 appropriations	Amounts accepted by States from—	
				1923 appropriation	1924 appropriation		1925 appropriation	1926 appropriation[4]
Alabama	$10,297.56	$10,297.56	$25,836.95	$25,836.95	$25,836.95	$25,836.95	$25,836.95	$25,836.95
Arizona	5,753.88	5,000.00	12,253.71	5,000.00	12,253.71	12,253.71	12,253.71	5,000.00
Arkansas	8,953.03	5,000.00	21,817.51	6,855.75	16,817.51	21,817.51	13,500.00	14,000.00
California	12,731.12	[5]	33,112.01	24,279.35	13,114.93	33,112.01	15,620.00	26,730.00
Colorado	7,119.83	5,000.00	16,337.20	9,976.99	9,999.33	16,337.20	10,000.00	10,000.00
Connecticut	8,114.75	8,114.75	19,311.48	9,655.74		19,311.48		

[1] Under the terms of the act each State accepting receives $5,000 outright; an additional $5,000 is available to each State if matched; the balance of the appropriation is distributed among the States, if matched, on the basis of population.

[2] Amounts shown are the amounts actually accepted by the States less refunds of unexpended balances returned to the Federal Treasury, as of June 30, 1926.

[3] Owing to the fact that only a few months of the 1922 fiscal year remained at the time the appropriation act for that year was passed a full appropriation was not made.

[4] These funds are available until July 1, 1927. Actual acceptances up to June 30, 1926, are here given.

[5] California and Illinois accepted the full amount available and Vermont accepted $5,000. However, these funds were not spent but were returned to the Federal Treasury.

Amounts available to States from Federal maternity and infancy funds and amounts accepted—Continued

States	Maximum amounts available from 1922 appropriation	Amounts accepted by States from 1922 appropriation	Maximum amounts available from 1923 and 1924 appropriations	Amounts accepted by States from—		Maximum amounts available from 1925 and 1926 appropriations	Amounts accepted by States from—	
				1923 appropriation	1924 appropriation		1925 appropriation	1926 appropriation
Delaware	5,503.10	5,503.10	11,504.01	11,504.01	11,504.01	11,504.01	11,504.01	11,504.01
Florida	7,184.90	5,000.00	16,531.72	8,621.28	16,531.72	16,531.72	16,531.72	16,531.72
Georgia	11,533.10	6,750.00	29,530.55	11,000.00	15,250.00	29,530.55	28,490.00	19,270.00
Hawaii						11,725.96	11,725.96	5,000.00
Idaho	5,974.30	5,000.00	12,912.66	6,250.00	7,912.66	12,912.66	5,691.60	9,308.40
Illinois	19,631.03	(5)	53,739.10			53,739.10		
Indiana	11,611.07	8,199.09	29,763.62	24,995.00	26,250.00	29,763.62	25,750.00	25,000.00
Iowa	10,423.56	10,423.56	26,213.60	26,213.60	26,213.60	26,213.60	26,213.60	26,213.60
Kansas	8,991.51	8,991.51	21,932.52	12,097.33		21,932.52		
Kentucky	10,452.00	10,452.00	26,298.64	26,298.64	26,298.64	26,298.64	26,298.64	26,298.64
Louisiana	9,057.50		22,129.80		17,590.60	22,129.80	22,127.79	5,000.00
Maine	6,732.66		15,179.77			15,179.77		
Maryland	8,270.49	7,913.57	19,777.05	19,277.05	19,269.05	19,777.05	19,164.58	19,277.00
Massachusetts	13,691.06		35,981.70			35,981.70		
Michigan	13,276.07	13,253.97	34,741.11	34,741.11	34,741.11	34,741.11	34,741.11	34,741.11
Minnesota	10,385.44	10,385.44	26,099.65	26,099.65	26,099.65	26,099.65	26,099.65	26,099.65
Mississippi	9,039.70	9,039.70	22,076.58	22,076.58	22,076.58	22,076.58	22,076.58	22,076.58
Missouri	12,679.67	12,473.15	32,958.19	28,527.38	21,762.17	32,958.19	24,000.00	5,000.00
Montana	6,238.31	6,238.31	13,701.91	13,701.91	13,701.91	13,701.91	13,701.91	13,700.00
Nebraska	7,924.66	7,924.66	18,743.21	17,661.69	7,409.50	18,743.21	11,915.00	8,845.00
Nevada	5,174.63	5,000.00	10,522.06	5,000.00	10,522.00	10,522.00	10,522.00	10,522.00
New Hampshire	5,999.61	5,000.00	12,988.31	5,000.00	12,988.31	12,988.31	12,988.31	12,988.31
New Jersey	12,119.83	12,119.83	31,284.55	31,284.55	31,284.55	31,284.55	31,284.55	31,284.55
New Mexico	5,812.96	5,812.96	12,430.33	12,430.33	12,236.40	12,430.33	12,430.33	12,430.33
New York	28,429.70		80,041.78		80,041.78	80,041.78	80,041.78	80,041.78
North Carolina	10,773.47	10,773.47	27,259.66	27,259.66	27,259.66	27,259.66	27,259.66	27,259.66
North Dakota	6,459.36	5,000.00	14,362.74	6,000.00	6,000.00	14,362.74	8,300.00	5,000.00
Ohio	17,993.41	7,187.95	48,843.46	11,900.00	17,393.04	48,843.46	26,606.96	43,843.46
Oklahoma	9,575.88	5,000.00	23,679.48	5,000.00	20,934.06	23,679.48	23,679.17	23,679.48
Oregon	6,767.35	6,232.61	15,283.46	8,000.00	15,283.46	15,283.46	15,283.46	5,000.00
Pennsylvania	24,672.69	24,667.12	68,810.99	68,810.20	68,810.99	68,810.99	68,810.99	68,810.99
Rhode Island	6,363.54		14,076.28		4,999.86	14,076.28	14,076.28	5,000.00
South Carolina	8,798.54	8,797.50	21,355.65	21,355.65	21,355.65	21,355.65	21,355.47	21,355.65
South Dakota	6,436.07	6,436.07	14,293.11	12,844.24	14,272.92	14,293.11	14,293.11	5,000.00
Tennessee	10,274.35	5,000.00	25,767.55	18,521.94	22,410.73	25,767.55	25,767.55	15,000.00
Texas	15,520.41	9,363.93	41,450.52	32,567.38	40,689.20	41,450.52	41,450.52	35,350.52
Utah	6,013.85	5,000.00	13,030.89	6,365.00	13,000.00	13,030.89	13,000.00	5,000.00
Vermont	5,795.09	(5)	12,376.90		2,775.33	12,376.90	5,000.00	5,000.00
Virginia	10,209.61	10,209.61	25,574.00	25,574.00	25,574.00	25,574.00	25,574.00	25,574.00
Washington	8,060.58	4,998.70	19,149.55	10,000.00	10,000.00	19,149.55	10,000.00	10,000.00
West Virginia	8,302.16	5,000.00	19,871.74	5,000.00	10,000.00	19,871.74	10,000.00	19,871.74
Wisconsin	10,938.04	8,995.03	27,751.62	27,750.44	27,751.62	27,751.62	27,751.62	27,751.62
Wyoming	5,438.57	4,998.87	11,311.12	5,000.00	11,000.00	11,311.12	6,600.00	6,600.00
Total	477,500.00	316,554.02	1,190,600.00	716,333.40	877,217.19	1,201,725.96	935,318.57	857,796.75

[5] California and Illinois accepted the full amount available and Vermont accepted $5,000. However, these funds were not spent but were returned to the Federal Treasury.

Reports of work during the fiscal year 1926 show that the 43 cooperating States and Hawaii held 1,945 combined prenatal and child-health conferences, 15,524 child-health conferences, and 2,686 prenatal conferences. Examinations were made at these conferences of 10,554 prospective mothers and of 159,244 infants and preschool children. The number of combined prenatal and child-health centers established was 135; of child-health centers, 140; and of prenatal centers, 8.

Two bulletins, Standards for Physicians Conducting Conferences in Child-Health Centers and Standards of Prenatal Care—An Outline for the Use of Physicians, prepared at the request of the State directors, were issued during the past year. The Children's Bureau advisory committee on pediatrics is responsible for the former, which was also approved by a number of other leading pediatricians. The Standards of Prenatal Care was prepared by a committee of obstetri-

cians who are leaders in their profession in different sections of the country. Both bulletins have been well received. Three medical schools are using the prenatal standards in their class work.

The conference of the State directors of maternity and infant hygiene was held at the Children's Bureau January 11 to 13, 1926. Directors or representatives were present from 41 States cooperating under the act. Representatives were also present from 3 of the 5 States not cooperating under the act, making a total of 44 of the 48 States represented.

The subjects discussed were: A practical State program in prenatal care; vital statistics and statistical studies in relation to maternity and infancy work; the infant and preschool child; education of public opinion in the hygiene of maternity and infancy; class work; and administrative problems.

Prominent obstetricians and pediatricians took part in the formal program and in the conference discussions. The papers read have been printed in various journals and form part of the conference proceedings which are now in press.

At the request of the conference two committees have been appointed and are now at work, one to consider a cost-accounting scheme with special reference to the unit cost of separate items of work, and one to investigate methods of determining time spent in maternity and infancy work by local agencies (county or city) matching funds as a part of the State program.

Representatives of the staff of the maternity and infant-hygiene division of the bureau have visited the States for the purpose of conferring with directors and seeing the work in progress. The accountant has visited all the cooperating States for the purpose of auditing accounts.

Special pieces of work undertaken by the Children's Bureau staff in 1925 at the request of State departments of health were completed in 1926 in Kentucky, New Mexico, North Dakota, Oregon, and Utah.

At the request of the State departments of health physicians were lent to Kentucky, North Carolina, North Dakota, and Oregon for child-health conferences. Georgia and Tennessee have had the help of the colored physician of the maternity and infant-hygiene division in working out a State program for negro midwives. A nurse from the Children's Bureau did a piece of work with Mexican midwives of New Mexico. A county nursing demonstration was carried on in Utah, and a nurse was lent to Nebraska to assist in organizing a state-wide plan for the examination of children of preschool age.

In its administration of the act the Children's Bureau has endeavored to live up to its spirit as expressed in section 14, which says its intent is "to secure to the various States control of the administration of this act within their respective States." The Federal overhead has been kept at a minimum; only 9 persons (3 physicians, 3 nurses, and 3 clerks) have been regularly employed in the maternity and infant-hygiene division.

The statistical division of the bureau has continued to assemble and interpret the available information on infant and maternal

mortality in foreign nations as well as in the United States. Six foreign countries have a lower infant mortality than the United States, according to the rates for 17 countries available for 1923. Foreign statistics for later years are not complete, but the trend of infant mortality in the United States has shown a marked improvement. The provisional rate of 72 announced for the United States birth-registration area for 1925 indicates that the reduction made in 1924 has been maintained.

The loss of mothers from causes connected with child bearing is greater in the United States than in any of the countries of Europe, upon the face of the maternal mortality rates assembled. Information concerning the comparability of these rates and statistics on the trend of maternal mortality over a series of years in the United States and other countries is given in a detailed analysis recently issued.[1]

Extension of the authorized appropriation for the maternity and infancy act.

Though the maternity and infancy act is permanent legislation the appropriation authorized under section 2 of the act is for a five-year period that expires June 30, 1927. In order that budget estimates might be made in the autumn of 1926 and that the 42 State legislatures meeting in January, 1927, might know what funds would be available, action during the present session of Congress seemed desirable. With the approval of the President the Secretary of Labor therefore recommended to the chairman of the Senate Committee on Education and Labor and of the House Committee on Interstate and Foreign Commerce, the committees which had had the measure before them in 1920 and 1921, that the appropriation in the amount originally authorized should be continued for the fiscal years 1928 and 1929. The reasons why this recommendation was made are as follows:

1. Five years is much too short a period to carry out a public-health program. It is a test as to whether the plan is calculated to secure the cooperation necessary for the success of such a program. It is believed that the maternity and infancy act has already passed this test successfully.

2. To discontinue cooperation now would result in loss of time and money spent in preliminary work. Some States had no child-health work under the State government before this act was passed. Foundation work has now been completed in nearly all the States so that actual developments on a state-wide scale will soon be under way. The work is primarily educational and its effects cumulative. To discontinue now will be to fail to secure the proportionately greater results that will follow this period of preliminary organization.

3. The infant mortality rate in the United States, though substantially lower in 1925 than in 1921, is still unnecessarily high. Provisional figures of the Census Bureau for 1925 indicate 72 deaths

[1] Maternal Mortality (the risk of death in childbirth and from all diseases caused by pregnancy and confinement), by Robert Morse Woodbury, Ph. D. U. S. Children's Bureau Publication No. 158. Washington, 1926.

per 1,000 live births in the registration area. In numbers this means an estimated total of 190,000 infants dying in the United States during their first year of life. It is possible to reduce this death rate. Five States—Nebraska, Iowa, Minnesota, Washington, and Oregon—have rates of 60 or below, and New Zealand had a rate of 40 in 1924. The types of work which the States are getting under way with maternity and infancy funds have proved successful in saving infant lives.

4. Maternal mortality in the United States is still high. The proportion of mothers dying in childbirth in the United States is higher than in most civilized countries for which comparable statistics are available. The maternal death rate reported by the vital-statistics division of the Bureau of the Census for 1924 was 6.6 per 1,000 live births in the birth-registration area. Conservative estimates indicate that of the 15,375 women who died in childbirth in the death-registration area in 1924 at least half could have been saved. The prenatal programs which the States are developing are fundamentally educational for the general public and for the individual mother who is reached through the conferences.

The bill introduced by the chairman of the House committee (H. R. 7555) embodying the suggestion made for a two-year extension of the maternity and infancy appropriation was favorably reported by the Committee on Interstate and Foreign Commerce and passed the House April 5, 1926, by a vote of 218 to 44. The House bill was reported to the Senate by the Committee on Education and Labor with an amendment providing that the appropriation should be extended for one year only—an entirely inadequate period of time. At the end of the session the bill had not come to a vote in the Senate. It remains on the Senate calendar, so that further action by the House will be unnecessary when Congress reconvenes in December.

CHILD HYGIENE

Washington rickets study.

The organization of the material secured in the Washington (D. C.) rickets study has been completed, and the report will be issued early in 1927. The material covered by this report includes the facts with regard to the incidence of rickets among 1,439 Washington children during the winter and the spring of 1922–23. The entire group had clinical examinations, and 926 of the children had roentgenographic examinations. The data derived from these examinations are correlated with the facts as to the nutritional, dietary, and hygienic conditions of the group studied.

New Haven rickets study.

The demonstration in New Haven of the control of rickets has continued during the past year along the same lines as in the two previous years. The three-year period for which the demonstration was planned comes to a close in September, 1926. The organization of the demonstration has remained the same, without changes in the staff. Continuing follow-up of as many of the babies born between

August 15, 1923, and October 1, 1925, as possible in the district selected for the study has been carried on intensively during the past year. Frequent examinations have been made, both physical and roentgenographic, to watch the progress of the child's growth.

Complete records have been kept of the child's food and sleep as well as the amounts of cod-liver oil and sunlight received. For comparison with this group of children which had the benefit of cod-liver oil and sunlight, a control group consisting of children who have received no cod-liver oil and whose parents have not been especially instructed regarding the value of sunlight, has been studied. The children of this control series have come from other districts of the city and have averaged approximately 13 months of age at the time of examination. A second control group consisting of the brothers and sisters of the babies and as many as possible of the other children under 5 years of age living within the district, were examined early in the study and followed from time to time throughout the period of the demonstration. Of the children born in the district during the period 597 initial examinations and 3,578 repeat examinations had been made up to June 30, 1926. Of the control group, 1,142 initial examinations and 311 repeat examinations were made. Altogether 5,519 roentgenograms have been taken and 12,620 home visits have been made by the nurses and 7,220 by the research assistants in connection with the general survey of the district and securing the social facts about families cooperating in the demonstration. The report of the results of the demonstration will be prepared as soon as possible after the study is completed.

Posture studies.

The material from the two-year posture study in Chelsea, Mass., completed in June, 1925, has been tabulated. In the course of this study the children of one room in each grade were given special posture training, and a record which included a physical examination at the beginning and at the end of the school year, monthly weight and height measurements, scholarship and deportment grades, and the number of absences due to illness in each school quarter was kept for each child. Similar records were kept for each child in other rooms where only the usual gymnastic exercises of the school were given. This second group of children formed a control group against which the progress of the posture-trained children could be measured.

Complete records were obtained for 1,708 children. (Records incomplete because the children dropped out of school, moved, etc., were not included in the analysis.) There were 961 children who had posture training for one year, and 747 children in control classes.

Before any posture training was given nine-tenths of the children had poor or bad posture. After a year three-fifths of the children receiving special training had improved their posture. The changes in posture of the two groups of children were as follows:

	Posture group (per cent)	Control group (per cent)
Improved posture	62.2	10.4
Unchanged posture	36.5	67.5
Poorer posture	1.2	22.1

Three-fifths of the children whose posture improved during the first year's training maintained or improved their posture during the summer vacation. After two years 87 per cent of the trained children had improved their posture, in contrast to one-tenth of those in control classes who improved, one-half whose posture did not change, and one-third whose posture was worse at the end of the two years.

Further analysis of the physical-examination records is being made to discover the relationship of correct posture to vital capacity, breadth and depth of chest, depth and circumference of abdomen, costal angle, and other measurements. The monthly height and weight measurements will afford a basis for a study of posture training in relation to growth. The records of scholarship, deportment, illness, all should throw light on the effect of corrected posture on these conditions.

Although the analysis of the physical-examination records is only partly completed it has already shown the value of this experiment not only as a means of training the children with whom it was conducted but as a demonstration of the desirability and possibility of posture training.

Two bulletins on posture have been prepared. The first one, Posture Clinics—Organization and Exercises, is intended for physicians, nurses, or physical-education teachers who are interested in the establishment of clinics for the correction of posture defects; the second, Posture Exercises—A Handbook for Schools and for Teachers of Physical Education, is intended primarily for teachers who are interested in training the child in the grade schools to develop good posture and thus prevent the postural defects which lead to various functional disorders. Posters, in sets of six, showing standards of good posture for boys and girls of the thin, intermediate, and stocky types have been prepared and are on sale at the Government Printing Office. The motion-picture film Posture has been completed, and both it and the charts are much in demand.

Crippled children.

The Children's Bureau study of public provision for clinic, hospital, and convalescent care, for education and employment service for crippled children in representative States has continued during the past year and will be completed early in 1927.

RECREATION

Requests for help in community recreation problems continue to come to the Children's Bureau. It has been possible to meet only a few of these. The field study of methods of supervision and control of commercial and community recreation in 14 cities has been completed and the report is in preparation.

CHILD LABOR AND THE EMPLOYMENT OF MINORS[2]

Child labor in fruit and vegetable canneries.

The most extensive undertaking of the industrial division of the bureau during the past year has been a study of the extent and

[2] See page 26 for legislation on this subject enacted during the past year.

conditions of child labor in fruit and vegetable canneries made in six important canning States of the East and Middle West, similar to the studies of child labor in shrimp and oyster canneries on the Gulf Coast and in South Atlantic States made in the winter and spring of 1925, and in the fish, fruit, and vegetable canneries of the State of Washington in the summer of 1923.[3]

This inquiry covers a somewhat wider field than the previous studies, as it relates not only to the ages and hours of labor of children at work and the enforcement of the State child labor laws with reference to these children but also to the occupations in which they are employed, the physical conditions under which they work, and the special problems of the migratory child worker in the canning industry, including housing, sanitation, and the methods of recruiting such labor. A special study was also made of 353 migratory families whose children were found at work in canneries visited by representatives of the bureau.

Inspections were made in 536 canneries in six States (Delaware, Indiana, Maryland, Michigan, New York, Wisconsin). These establishments together employed approximately 52,000 persons, of whom 3,276, employed in 473 establishments, were under 16 years of age, 1,120, or more than one-third of these, being less than 14, or under the legal age for employment in canneries in all but one of the States included in the inquiry. In this State, in which children of 12 years of age could legally be employed in canneries during school vacations, 114 children under this age were at work, many of them after the opening of school in the fall. In all, 302 of the children were less than 12 years of age, 57 of these being under 10. A number of children, including some too young for legal employment in canneries under the child labor laws of their States, were working in hazardous occupations or under conditions detrimental to their health or safety.

Hours of work were long for the majority of the children, reliable information obtained from time records or other sources showing that at least 2,771, or more than four-fifths of the working children under 16 (including 966 children under 14), had worked over eight hours a day. In the canning industry long work days at the peak of the season are customary, and in a number of States this industry is exempt from the legal hour restrictions applicable to women and minors in other factory work. In all six of the States included in this inquiry the hours of labor of children in factory work were regulated by law, but in three of these States canneries were specifically exempted. In the other three the maximum 8-hour day and 48-hour week for factory work covered work in canneries; but though the proportion of workers under 16 employed more than eight hours a day was less in these States than in those in which there was no legal regulation as to hours (59 per cent as compared with 92 per cent) their number (476) was not inconsiderable. Moreover, a large proportion of the children under 16 years of age (2,174, or about three-fifths of the total) worked 10 hours or more; one-

[3] Thirteenth Annual Report of the Chief of the Children's Bureau, p. 9, Washington, 1925; Twelfth Annual Report of the Chief of the Children's Bureau, p. 12, Washington, 1924.

fifth (684) worked 12 hours or more; 246 (87 of whom were girls) worked 14 hours or more, and 62 (including 9 girls) worked from 16 up to 20 hours. Weekly hours also were in many cases excessive. A considerable number of children worked at night. Almost two-fifths (1,241, or 38 per cent) of those under 16, including 421 under 14 years of age, were found to have been employed between the hours of 7 p. m. and 6 a. m., contrary to the provisions of the former Federal child labor laws and of the laws regulating the work of children in factories in 34 States at the present time. Night work is not regulated in canneries in the three States included in this study which do not regulate the maximum daily and weekly hours of employment, although prohibited in other kinds of factory employment. In the three States in which legal prohibition exists 265, or 33 per cent, of the child workers under 16 were employed between 7 p. m. and 6 a. m., as compared with 976, or 39 per cent, of the children in the three States in which no such legal regulation exists.

One of the principal means of insuring an adequate basis for the enforcement of child labor laws is a good system for the issuance of employment certificates. Employment certificates are required by law for all children between 14 and 16 years of age employed in canneries in five of the six States in which the inquiry was made; in one of these States certificates are required up to 17 years of age, in another up to 18. Certificates were found on file for only one-half of the 2,736 minors legally required to obtain them, the proportion varying from 20 per cent in one State to 95 per cent in another. It was found also that certificates had been issued to 267 children under 14 (the legal minimum age in the five States where certificates were required), almost all of these, however, (259) being in one State. Moreover, in the case of a large proportion of the certificates on file, one or more errors or defects in issuing were found. Some of these defects were not in themselves of much significance in relation to the adequate enforcement of the law, but many of them were more serious. For example, in 399 cases (371 of these, however, being in one State) the birth date on the certificate was wrongly stated; in 363 cases (340 of which were in this one State) the child was in fact younger than the age given on the certificate. In 251 cases the evidence reported on the certificate (in most cases a birth certificate) as having been accepted by the issuing officer was found to be nonexistent. The relationship between an adequate certificate system and the enforcement of other provisions of the State child labor law is indicated by the fact that the State having the largest proportion (95 per cent) of children with certificates had the smallest proportion of children employed in violation of the age and hour standards of the State child labor law, and the State having the largest proportion of defective certificates had the largest proportion of children employed in violation of these standards. This comparison is especially significant in view of the fact that in both these States the State enforcing agency is responsible for the issuing of employment certificates or for the appointing or approving the appointment of the local officials authorized to issue certificates throughout the State.

To summarize, the study shows that children under 16 are ver generally employed in the canning industry; that in some State because of the exemption of canneries from the laws regulatin the work of children in other manufacturing industries, many chi dren are employed without adequate legal protection; and that eve in States where laws exist for their protection a very considerab number of children are employed in violation of these laws. How ever, when the figures obtained in the different States included i the present inquiry are examined separately, they show a grea variation between the States in the extent to which children a employed in violation of the prescribed legal standards. For e ample, the proportion of children under 16 who are employed belo the legal working age, which is about one-third of the total numbe varies from 43 per cent in one State to 2 per cent in another, an the proportion of minors employed in violation of the State hou standards varies from 11 per cent to 92 per cent. In spite of th greater difficulty of enforcement of legal standards in the cannin than in other manufacturing industries, this variation indicates tha where a sincere and well-considered effort is made on the part of th State to see that the law is enforced good conditions are possible.

Children engaged in industrial home work in New Jersey.

In 1919 the bureau made a survey of industrial home work amon children and the general effect which factory work done in th home has upon the welfare of the children of families engaged i it in three cities in Rhode Island.[4] During the last year a secon inquiry in regard to industrial home work among children was ma by the bureau as a part of a series of studies of child welfare New Jersey.

The New Jersey study covered seven selected communities which home work was reported by State authorities—Newark, Vin land, South River, North Bergen, Paterson, Sayreville, and Har monton. The families were located through a canvass made bureau agents of children under 16 attending the public schoo The homes of all those who reported that they had been engag in some form of factory home work were visited and the children a their parents interviewed. Parochial-school children, who form considerable proportion of the school population in the larger citi were not interviewed in this study. Information was obtained f all who had been engaged in industrial home work for one mon or more during the year preceding the interview. In Newark 8 children were found in the 459 families in which home work w done, and in the other six communities 282 children in 169 famili

The State department of labor endeavors to discourage the emplo ment of children in home work as much as possible by refusing issue licenses to families to engage in home work in cases wh inspectors of the department believe that children are likely to drawn into service, and applicants for licenses are warned that children are found working in their homes their licenses will

[4] See Industrial Home Work of Children; a study made in Providence, Pawtucket, Central Falls, R. I. (U. S. Children's Bureau Publication No. 100, Washington, 1922).

revoked. Though the State department during the last few years has given special attention to the enforcement of the laws relating to home work, children as young as 5 were found to have been engaged in such work for at least a month's time during the year. Almost one-fourth of the children who had done industrial home work in these families were under 10 years of age and almost four-fifths were under 14, the legal age for factory employment under the New Jersey child labor law.

As in other eastern cities, it was found that the families doing home work in the New Jersey communities were chiefly those of immigrants. In all but one of the communities the great majority were Italian. As a rule factory work in the home is a family activity; mother and children, and sometimes the father and relatives or others who are members of the household, all help with the work. The household group of the home-working family is usually large. Over half the households consisted of between 7 and 13 members, and in the majority of them from 3 to 7 persons contributed help in the home work for at least 26 days in the year.

The principal lines of manufacture in which children were found to be engaged were as follows, in the order of their importance: Making men's clothing, ladies' dresses and coats (beading and embroidering), powder puffs, tags, artificial flowers, and dolls' garments; embroidering handkerchiefs; cutting laces and embroideries; making strips for brassieres and corsets, bracelets and necklaces, buttons, Christmas cards and seals, safety pins, neckties, ladies' underwear, embroidery floss, babies' bootees and socks, fireworks, children's and babies' dresses. The work on the various articles is subdivided in the family group into jobs suited to workers of different ages and degrees of skill. Thus, children under 8 were found working at such simple tasks as pulling bastings from men's coats and sorting and stringing tags. As they grow older they undertake the more difficult processes. Children also usually carry between the home and the contractor or employer the raw materials and finished product worked on by the entire family group.

"Speeding up" was common, particularly in the highly seasonal industries. Although the children as a rule work irregularly they may be kept at their tasks for long hours during the season when employers are giving out large quantities of work. Even while school was in session one-eighth (13 per cent) of the children worked four, five, and six hours a day, which meant night work for many of them.

Although it was found that a certain number of the families doing industrial home work, including some in which very young children were at work, enjoyed a fairly comfortable income from other sources, the New Jersey inquiry confirmed the findings of other studies of the economic aspects of the home-work problem—that in most cases the work was undertaken to supplement an inadequate family income. More than half (57 per cent) of the families were found to earn from employment other than industrial home work less than $1,450 a year, though the average number of persons in a family was over six. In many families the employment in which the chief breadwinner was engaged was seasonal or irregular. The earnings derived

from home work were very small, since rates of pay are low, most of the work is seasonal and irregular, and deductions for the loss or the spoiling of material and expenditures for equipment lessen the net earnings. More than half the families (59) made less than $150 a year from their home work.

According to the records of the State department of labor, though approximately 2,900 licenses were effective in the State at the time of the inquiry, only a very small proportion of the families interviewed were found to be licensed. Though the efforts of the State department to enforce the law have doubtless reduced the evil the difficulties inherent in the enforcement of any licensing system are great and the situation in New Jersey presents special problems because the law penalizes only the "owner, lessee, or occupant" of the place in which the work is done. The State department has urged an amendment of the law that would impose a penalty for violation upon the employer or contractor, the only method from which any reasonable degree of effectiveness may be expected. A bill incorporating such a provision was introduced in the New Jersey Legislature in 1924, but it failed to pass.

Vocational opportunities for minors.

Studies of the vocational opportunities for minors in a number of industries and occupations have been made in connection with this survey of child labor in New Jersey.

The field work in connection with the studies of vocational opportunities for normal children based on the work histories of employed minors attending continuation school in Milwaukee, Wis., and in Newark and Paterson, N. J., begun in the winter and spring of 1925, was completed during the past year. Analysis of the information obtained through these inquiries for some 10,000 working boys and girls, now in process of tabulation, will furnish facts not only as to the occupations actually engaged in by boys and girls of different ages, education, and specialized training but also as to the extent to which sex, age, amount of education, and special vocational preparation affect the young worker's opportunity for success on the job, for promotion, his wages, stability of employment, etc.

Work histories of minors mentally or physically handicapped.

During the past year a preliminary analysis has been made of information obtained in a study of the work histories of approximately 1,000 young persons who had formerly been enrolled in the special classes for mental defectives in seven cities—Detroit, Rochester, Newark, Cincinnati, Oakland, San Francisco, and Los Angeles. The majority of these young persons could be classified mentally as middle-grade morons, although some were only slightly subnormal, and a few were high-grade imbeciles.

It was found that the great majority went into work of an unskilled or semiskilled type that required little if any preliminary training. More than half of all the jobs held by both boys and girls since leaving school were in the manufacturing and mechanical industries, the great majority being employed as semiskilled opera-

tives in factories, chief among which were those manufacturing automobiles and other metal goods, foodstuffs, clothing, lumber and furniture, shoes, electrical supplies, and paper boxes. The next largest number of jobs for the boys were those classified by the census under transportation, and these comprised 12.3 per cent of all their jobs. They were most frequently employed as teamsters, truck and taxi drivers, and telegraph and special-delivery messengers. The same tendency toward work of this kind was shown in the large number of jobs on delivery wagons and trucks among boys in occupations classified under trade, which was the third largest group of occupations for boys. Next to factory work girls were engaged chiefly in personal and domestic service, as household servants, nursemaids, restaurant workers, and laundry operatives. Many of them also were salesgirls in stores. Clerical jobs, chiefly in messenger and errand service for the boys, and some office work and clerical jobs for both boys and girls, comprised 6.5 per cent of all occupations.

The average cash wages for beginners of both sexes, all occupations being taken into consideration, were between $12 and $14, and the last cash wage, which meant the wage at the time of the interview, or the last previous wage if the individual was unemployed at the time of the interview, averaged between $16 and $20. More increases in pay and likewise more promotions to jobs of greater responsibility were reported for the boys and girls with the higher intelligence quotients than for those with the lower intelligence quotients.

In interviewing employers an attempt was made to obtain reports as to whether boys and girls were rated as satisfactory or unsatisfactory in their work, and an expression of opinion was secured for a little more than half the jobs studied. Among boys 78 per cent of the jobs, and among girls 80 per cent, were satisfactorily performed. The proportion doing satisfactory work varied somewhat with the intelligence quotient, more especially among the girls; the difference in this regard between boys of low mentality and those who were more nearly normal was not very great. The types of jobs unsatisfactorily performed were principally in messenger service, clerical work, and apprenticeships in skilled trades.

Data obtained for all who had been on probation under juvenile or under adult courts, or who had served sentences in penal institutions showed that 14 per cent had court records. A comparison of the work histories of these young persons with those of the nondelinquent showed that on an average they had much more unemployment, their longest jobs lasted for a shorter time, they changed oftener from one job to another, and they were inclined to be less satisfactory in their work even when their intelligence ratings placed them in the middle and upper moron groups rather than in the lower groups.

The study as a whole would seem to indicate that there is a place for subnormal boys and girls in industry. Even those who showed little mental ability could perform certain types of work satisfactorily. Of these subnormal young people those in the lower

grade had held their last jobs longer than those of higher mental level; this probably indicates that they were more willing to settle down at tasks that were monotonous and irksome to those of higher intelligence. The percentages of promotions for the different intelligence groups and wage increases in last over first jobs show that ability to progress increased with a higher intelligence quotient.

The fact that so many young persons of less than average mentality were able to earn a livelihood is doubtless due in part to the training given them while in the special classes, in good habit formation and in a right attitude toward work.

A similar study of the work histories of young persons formerly inmates of the State institutions for the feeble-minded in Illinois is at present under way. The problems of the physically handicapped child in industry also deserve special consideration, and it is hoped that within the next few years the bureau will be able to make studies relating to the work records of various groups of physically handicapped children, and of the relationship of occupations of different kinds to the physical well-being of children and young persons engaged in them. It is hoped that the bureau may also soon be able to meet the increasing demand for information regarding the methods that are being developed in various places to meet the special problems of the physically and mentally handicapped children in their transition from school to work and their subsequent vocational adjustment.

Statistics of children leaving school for work.

During the last year the bureau has received from State departments of labor, education, or child welfare in 16 States statistics relating to children receiving work permits or employment certificates during the calendar year 1925. Some of the States have furnished statistics for their principal cities also. In addition local boards of education or other agencies responsible for the issuance of work permits in 27 other cities have sent in reports.

The accompanying table shows the number of 14 and 15 year old children receiving permits to go to work in 1924 and 1925 in 12 States and 29 cities having a population of 100,000 or over, for which the bureau has received information covering both 1924 and 1925:

Number of children between 14 and 16 years of age receiving regular employment certificates for the first time, 1924 and 1925, and per cent of increase or decrease as compared with preceding year, by State and city[1]

State and city	1924	Per cent of increase (+) or decrease (−) as compared with 1923	1925	Per cent of increase (+) or decrease (−) as compared with 1924
Alabama	911		1,005	+10.3
Birmingham	149	−37.9	179	+20.1
California:				
San Francisco	243	−36.2	267	+9.9
Connecticut	5,995		7,605	+26.9
Bridgeport	605	−41.4	785	+29.8
Hartford	572	−38.2	676	+18.2
New Britain	348	−30.8	478	+37.4
New Haven	810	−34.4	927	+14.4
Waterbury	540	−23.2	634	+17.4
District of Columbia	412	−13.1	134	−67.5
Illinois:				
Chicago	5,443		4,962	−8.8
Indiana	1,109		966	−12.9
Indianapolis	286	−60.6	255	−10.8
Kansas	94		63	−33.0
Kentucky	841		889	+5.7
Louisville	640	−19.5	547	−14.5
Louisiana:				
New Orleans [2]	2,288	−8.1	2,506	+9.5
Maryland [3]	3,768		4,132	+9.7
Baltimore [4]	3,526	−14.9	3,948	+12.0
Massachusetts [5]	13,296		15,230	+14.5
Fall River	789	−50.0	1,134	+43.7
New Bedford [6]	1,085	−24.6	1,452	+33.8
Michigan:				
Detroit	361	+30.3	410	+13.6
Minnesota:				
Minneapolis	165	−45.2	196	+18.8
St. Paul	185	−10.6	180	−2.7
Missouri:				
St. Louis	3,366	−32.4	3,528	+4.8
New Hampshire	466		516	+10.7
New Jersey	16,619		17,820	+7.2
Jersey City	1,574	−25.0	1,593	+1.2
Newark	2,193	−12.6	2,237	+2.0
Trenton	784	−19.5	920	+17.3
New York:				
New York City	32,163	−11.9	32,814	+2.0
Rochester	1,580	−18.1	1,833	+16.0
Yonkers	284	−65.1	384	+35.2
Oklahoma	304		282	−7.2
Pennsylvania:				
Philadelphia	8,289	−24.2	10,349	+24.9
Pittsburgh	1,864	−32.9	2,028	+8.8
Reading	903	−19.6	1,155	+27.9
Tennessee	2,540		3,062	+20.6
West Virginia	743		570	−23.3
Wisconsin:				
Milwaukee	1,926	−49.0	2,481	+28.8

[1] Compiled, except where otherwise noted, from figures furnished by certificating officers, school officials, etc., in correspondence with the United States Children's Bureau.

[2] Report of the factories' inspection department of the parish of Orleans for the year ending Dec. 31, 1923, p. 7; 1924, p. 10; 1925, p. 4.

[3] Annual report of the commissioner of labor and statistics of Maryland for the year 1923, pp. 28, 42; 1924, pp. 33, 47; 1925, pp. 23, 40.

[4] Ibid., 1923, p. 23; 1924, p. 33; 1925, p. 23.

[5] Statistics for the State of Massachusetts and for Massachusetts cities exclude children receiving "home permits" and those receiving subsequent certificates, even though the certificate may be the first of its type.

[6] Annual report of the school committee of the city of New Bedford for the year 1923, p. 18; 1924, p. 17; 1925, p. 17.

Children between 14 and 16 years of age receiving work permits in the places reporting to the bureau are probably more than half the total number of children of these ages going to work throughout the country in occupations for which permits are required. Al-

though they include neither the large number entering occupations, such as farm work and domestic service, for which no certificate is required, nor those going to work without complying with the law, the statistics are representative of conditions in all sections of the United States and in most of the important child-employing centers as regards at least the legal employment of children of work-permit age in most industrial and commercial pursuits.

Eight of the States and 24 of the cities reported an increase in the calendar year 1925 as compared with 1924 in the number of children between 14 and 16 years of age entering regular employment for the first time. These increases followed decreases in 1924, as compared with 1923, for all places reporting except Detroit, where there was an increase in both 1924 and 1925. The largest decrease, 67 per cent, in Washington, D. C., followed an amendment to the compulsory school attendance law of the District of Columbia, effective February 4, 1925, which requires a child to remain in school up to the age of 16 unless he has completed the eighth grade.

Although the number of children receiving work permits in any particular place may increase with the extension of the certificate law to more types of employment or with better enforcement of the law, so that an increase in the number of certificates does not always mean an increase in the number of children going to work in that place, and although the number may decrease with the lowering of the administrative standards, so that a decrease does not necessarily indicate a decline in the number of children going to work, nevertheless when increases or decreases occur in a large number of places, it is probably safe to assume that differences in the actual number of children employed are responsible rather than differences in enforcement of the law or extensions of its application. The larger number of permits issued in 1925 is probably due to a revival of business resulting in the employment of more children than during the preceding year.

Employment-certificate figures not only are of value as an indication of the number of children entering legal employment but are also an important source of information on such points as the age and sex of children going to work, the school grade completed by young workers, and the occupations that they enter. In order to ascertain the trend over a period of years in the age at beginning work, the amount of education acquired before leaving school, and similar data, the bureau has attempted during the last year to assemble all available information on these points found in published reports on certificate issuance or procured through correspondence with State and city officials. An increasing number of State and city offices are furnishing the bureau currently with this type of information.

Laws affecting the employment of minors, and their administration.

Compilations of laws affecting child labor and compulsory school attendance passed by the State legislatures in 1925 and of nearly all such laws passed in 1926 have been completed during the year. New editions of the following publications revised to include the latest legislative changes, have been issued during the year or are practically ready for the printer: Chart 1, State Child Labor

Standards;[5] Chart 2, State Compulsory School Attendance Standards Affecting the Employment of Minors;[5] Publication No. 114, Child Labor in the United States, Ten Questions Answered; Publication No. 79, Physical Standards for Working Children; Publication No. 93, Child Labor—Outlines for Study.

A revision to date of the complete texts of the child labor and compulsory school attendance laws of the various States published by the bureau in 1915 is partly completed. The large amount of legislation enacted since the preparation of the first edition of this compilation, and the publication of many of the laws in new codes, have rendered the old edition practically useless as a source of information regarding the legislation in effect in many States at the present day. It is hoped that the new edition of these texts, together with a series of charts summarizing their principal provisions in revised form, will be ready for publication within a few months.

Work has been started in connection with the preparation of an analysis of the principal provisions of child-labor legislation in foreign countries, much needed because of the numerous requests for information on this subject received by the bureau. Supplementary information is also being obtained relative to the administration of such laws and the nature and extent of the specific problems which the regulation of child labor presents in the principal foreign countries.

Two projects, (1) a detailed study of the various prohibited and regulated occupations enumerated in the State laws as to the employment of minors in hazardous and injurious trades, and (2) a study of the application of workmen's compensation laws to the employment of children, both originally planned for the year just closed, had to be postponed. It is hoped they will be undertaken in 1927.

STUDIES OF DEPENDENT CHILDREN

The extent of child dependency in the United States.

The Children's Bureau has in preparation a short bulletin which analyzes the available statistical data with reference to children cared for by institutions, by child-placing agencies, and by public aid to children in their own homes. Not including the children assisted or supported by family-welfare societies, the dependent children in the United States number approximately 350,000, according to available reports.

Public aid to children in their own homes.

A brief bulletin on Public Aid to Mothers with Dependent Children, prepared by the director of the social-service division, is now in press. It summarizes the history of the legislation, its status in 1926, and the problems connected with administration and supervision and the determination of the standards to be followed in the amount of aid given.

The report on a study of the standards followed in the administration of the so-called mothers' pension laws, particularly with

[5] Prepared by the Children's Bureau but printed by the Federal Board for Vocational Education.

reference to health, housing, education, and recreation, in 10 localities, has been completed. The localities selected included six counties in which a large city was included; one county coterminous with a large city; one county including a small city; one city; and the Province of Manitoba, Canada, with special reference to the city of Winnipeg. There were four types of administrative agencies in these 10 localities: 1. An unpaid commission or board with a paid executive; 2. A paid board of public welfare, the work being under the immediate direction of a paid executive; 3. The juvenile court, with or without advising committees; 4. A "bureau" directly responsible to the finance committee of the county board of supervisors.

With possibly two exceptions, all the agencies gave careful attention to the correction of physical defects, and it was the intention of all of them that no mother or child should go without necessary medical care for lack of knowledge as to medical resources.

One especially significant fact brought out by this study is the emphasis being placed in some localities on giving the children educational opportunities that will make for their future success and happiness. Excluding one county in which the law required school attendance up to 16 years of age, there were 1,502 children 14 and 15 years of age under the supervision of the agencies included in the study. Of this number 1,147 (76 per cent) were in school; 308 (21 per cent) were working; and 47 (3 per cent) were neither in school nor at work (most of these children were in ill health, and a few were mentally defective).

It appeared to be customary for working children 14 and 15 years of age to turn over their entire earnings to their mothers. Twenty-six per cent of the total income in families under the supervision of six of the agencies was derived from the wages of the children.

One of the most serious handicaps in 6 out of the 10 agencies was the lack of an adequate administrative staff.

Standards of child-placing agencies.

The report of the investigation of the organization and methods employed by 10 agencies providing foster-home care for dependent children is in press. The study included agencies in New England, as well as in the Middle Atlantic, Southern, and Middle Western States; it thus covered territory with many child-welfare agencies where intake could be controlled with a view to intensive concentration on certain problems, and territory with little or no other organized child-welfare work where the child-placing agency had to meet all local needs.

The report includes discussion of the causes of dependency, and the amount contributed by parents or relatives to the support of 4,887 children under care of eight of the agencies at the time of the inquiry. It also describes the investigation of social, physical, and mental facts before acceptance of children for placement, investigation of foster homes, standards required for acceptance of a home, the policy with reference to adoption, and the maintenance of contacts with the children's relatives which are followed by the various societies.

A second section of the report includes a discussion of the health supervision of children in foster homes under the care of 10 child-

placing agencies. This section describes the work of agencies whose health programs are based upon community medical resources available without cost, as well as the work of agencies providing facilities of their own for health supervision.

Centralized investigation of institutional intake.

Institutions for children are misnamed orphanages, since very few of the children they care for have lost both parents. Studies recently made indicate that both parents of probably as many as two-thirds of the children whose care is assumed by the State or by a private agency are living. This raises the presumption that many of these removals may be unnecessary and points to the importance of adequate investigation before admission. A central bureau of investigation is intended not only to meet this need but also to make available to the community a conception of the whole problem of child dependency which it must meet.

Because of a growing interest among agencies dealing with dependent children in the usefulness of these central bureaus in meeting the problems of institutional intake of children, the United States Children's Bureau began a study of the Cleveland Children's Bureau in April, 1925. The Cleveland Children's Bureau is unique in being a central clearing agency which serves all the institutions of the city with the exception of two Jewish ones. The study covers the organization and development of the Cleveland bureau during the four years of its existence (1921–1925) and a careful investigation of the records of 1,416 families which were referred to it during the year ended March 31, 1923, and the year ended March 31, 1925.

The primary purpose of the study of records as planned by the United States Children's Bureau was to ascertain the antecedent conditions in the lives of dependent children which contributed to their appearance as candidates for institutional care, with the hope that some light might be thrown upon means of preventing the dependency of children, and secondly to determine the means that are being used to prevent dependency in a given community where the whole problem is known. The study as it nears completion shows that the greatest causes for dependency as disclosed by the records of the Cleveland Children's Bureau were physical and mental disability—413 families out of a total of 1,416 gave illness as the reason aid was requested; desertion of one or both parents—115 families gave this as the reason for requesting care of children; death of one or both parents—134 families. These figures represent causes of dependency as given at the time of application by the family or agency referring the family. Primary causes as found by investigation after acceptance of application are also illness, desertion, and death.

In the 1,416 families there were a total of 4,236 children, and of this number 3,074 were included in this study as being children for whose care application had been made or children who, investigation disclosed, were in need of care though originally no application had been made for them. Of the children considered for care 2,380 were with one or both parents at the time application for assistance was made. The recommendations for the care of children made by the

Cleveland Children's Bureau were institutional care for 911 children, family-agency care for families with a total of 721 children, and care by a home-finding society for families with a total of 320 children. Furthermore, the Cleveland Children's Bureau undertook the supervision of 117 children in their own homes.

DELINQUENCY AND CHILD WELFARE

The trend in juvenile delinquency.

In response to many requests the Children's Bureau has assembled such information as can be secured from the annual reports of juvenile courts and reports of the Bureau of the Census with reference to the trend in juvenile delinquency. A study of this material indicates (1) that the present condition of juvenile-court statistics is unsatisfactory and (2) that according to the evidence available juvenile delinquency has decreased.

Lack of uniformity in methods of compiling statistics used in the courts and marked variations in inclusions and methods of presentation, make the statistics practically valueless for purposes of comparing delinquency rates in one city with those of other cities. The fact that for only 14 cities of 100,000 population and over in the entire United States can information be obtained on which delinquency rates can be computed over a period of years indicates the woeful inadequacy of statistical material regarding the work of an institution as important as the juvenile court.

The figures for these 14 widely separated cities (Boston, Buffalo, Chicago, Detroit, Minneapolis, New Orleans, New York, Philadelphia, Providence, Richmond, Rochester, St. Louis, Seattle, Washington, D. C.), covering in most instances the 10-year period from 1915 to 1924, doubtless indicate the trend in juvenile delinquency. That 9 of the 14 show a decrease in the delinquency rate (that is, the number of cases of delinquency per 1,000 children of the delinquency age fixed by the juvenile court law) at the end of the period as compared with the beginning and that only 4 show an increase (available rates for 1 being practically stationary), furnishes a strong presumption that sensational statements regarding increase of juvenile crime do not have a basis in fact. Moreover, much more reliable figures as to commitments to institutions, based on census reports covering the entire country, indicate a decline in the number of delinquent children committed to institutions, if growth in population be taken into consideration, and reveal no significant increase in the numbers committed for the more serious offenses—homicide, robbery, and burglary. According to the census reports, the age of commitment to penal institutions has not decreased, as has frequently been asserted.

Uniform reporting of juvenile-court statistics.

The plan for reporting of juvenile-court statistics of delinquency, dependency, and neglect on which the Children's Bureau has been at work for the past two years was published during the year as a bulletin entitled "Juvenile-Court Statistics." This bulletin contains an introductory statement of the purpose of juvenile-court statistics and the methods by which they may be obtained, and a description

of the plan proposed by the Children's Bureau, with outlines of the statistical cards to be used and the tables to be compiled.

In the preparation of the plan the bureau had the cooperation of the committee on records and statistics of the National Probation Association and of others who are familiar with statistical problems of the courts.

A representative of the bureau is now visiting courts and State departments having supervisory authority or power to require reports from juvenile courts and is working out with these courts and departments the methods by which the plan may be made to fit in with present systems of recording, filing, and summarizing the data called for. The cooperation of a number of courts and State departments has already been assured.

Crime and delinquency among Chicago boys 17 to 20 years of age.

A study of delinquency and crime among boys above juvenile-court age in Chicago was begun late in the year. Information is being assembled from annual reports of the municipal court, the police department, and the county jail concerning the trend in statistics of delinquency and crime among boys 17 to 20 years of age, inclusive, during the last 10 years. A study of the cases of approximately 850 boys dealt with by the boys' court—a branch of the municipal court—in 1924 and 1925, based on records of courts and social agencies, is being made, and detailed information concerning 100 of these boys will be obtained through home visits and record studies.

Domestic-relations courts.

Progress has been made on a report entitled "The Child, the Family, and the Court," which embodies the legal and statistical information and descriptive material concerning courts dealing with domestic relations and juvenile problems which the Children's Bureau has for some time been engaged in assembling. A small conference of experts is planned for the coming year in which committees of the National Probation Association and National Association of Legal Aid Organizations and representatives of other organizations will be invited to participate.

Living conditions of prisoners' families—Kentucky.

At the request of the Kentucky State Commission on Prison Labor, which was appointed in 1926 by the governor of the State, the Children's Bureau has undertaken a study of living conditions of the families of prisoners in the two State penal institutions, the reformatory and the penitentiary. The aim of the study is to obtain information concerning the effect of the father's imprisonment on the standard of living of the family and the welfare of the children, and the extent to which public and private relief agencies are bearing part of the financial burden caused by the father's imprisonment. The total number of prisoners in the two institutions included in the study was 2,290 on March 15, 1926, of whom 724, according to the records of the institutions, had children under 16 years of age. The families selected for the field study were those of prisoners with children under 16 years of age on the above date, who had been

imprisoned nine months or more and were reported as living with their families prior to imprisonment. On this basis 329 families were selected for special study, and 220 from all sections of the State were located and the information secured on which a report will be made to the commission.

STATE AND COUNTY CHILD-WELFARE ACTIVITIES

County studies.

The results of studies made by the Children's Bureau with special reference to conditions in selected counties in Georgia, Pennsylvania, North Carolina, Minnesota, and New York have been prepared for publication. These reports show the child-caring work done under the different laws and widely varying conditions which these States present.

Child welfare in New Jersey.

The field work on the studies of child welfare in New Jersey undertaken at the request of the State board of institutions and agencies has been completed. Preliminary reports on the child placing and the administration of the public aid to dependent children by the board of children's guardians have already been submitted to the State board of institutions and agencies, and final reports are now being prepared.

The board of children's guardians was organized in New Jersey to have general oversight of all poor and dependent children, the condition of children cared for in almshouses having created the public demand for this work by the State. The method used from the beginning was family-home placement. Other duties were given the board by the legislature from time to time. The placement of children in family homes remains, however, a very important part of the board's work. On June 1, 1925, the board had under care 1,765 children in boarding homes and 1,117 children in free homes. The report is a careful study of investigations made before children are accepted for care, the investigation of homes, standards required of foster homes, supervision after placement, and policy with reference to adoption.

The material for the report on mothers' aid in New Jersey was secured by (1) a statistical study based on the board's records of all families receiving mothers' allowances between April 1, 1920, and March 31, 1925, (2) observation of the methods and staff used for this work at the central office, (3) observation of the work of the members of the field staff on their regular assignments, (4) intensive study of a limited number of family histories.

On July 1, 1925, the State board had in its care 2,510 families under the act to promote home life for dependent children. Under the dependent children's act 412 mothers were receiving board for their children under supervision of the board, and in 169 families the children were placed "free" with their mothers under the same supervision. This made a total of 3,091 families for whose welfare the State board was charged with responsibility. In 2,922 of these families—2,510 which received the aid called "mothers' pension" and 412 in which board was paid to the mother—relief from public

funds was being paid on the recommendation of the State board. During the fiscal year 1924 relief to the mothers' pension families totaled $637,074.32. The amount paid as board to the mothers under the dependent children's act was not available, as the statistics for these families were not kept separately from those relating to children in foster homes, but was approximately an additional $200,000.

The reports of the study of juvenile courts and probation in the four counties selected for intensive study, and of the institutions for delinquent boys and girls and the parole system used for these institutions, are now being written, as well as the reports of the more general studies of the development of public supervision and control of the agencies and institutions of New Jersey, the selection of public personnel, the cooperation of private family and child-caring agencies, and the State's efforts to develop local responsibility for a preventive program.

Reference has already been made to the investigation of child labor in New Jersey, which forms a part of this general survey of New Jersey's child-welfare problems and resources.

LEGAL RESEARCH IN THE SOCIAL-SERVICE DIVISION

Current research necessary to supply material requested by State child-welfare commissions and other public and private agencies and for bureau reports has occupied most of the time of the expert in legal research of the social-service division of the bureau. Maps showing the provisions of the various State laws relating to public aid to children in their own homes, juvenile courts, jail detention of children, age of consent, and adoption have also been prepared. Some progress has been made on the analysis of the laws relating to placed-out children, which it is hoped will go to press during the coming year.

STATE CHILD-WELFARE COMMISSIONS

State commissions for the study and revision of child-welfare laws have been active during the last year in only five States—Georgia, New York, Pennsylvania, South Dakota, and Rhode Island—in the District of Columbia, and in Porto Rico. A child-welfare board was organized in Porto Rico late in 1925, in accordance with a law of that year creating such a board to study all problems affecting childhood, revise legislation, and inspect institutions. The board is to report at each regular session of the legislature. The South Carolina State Board of Public Welfare, in its annual report for 1925, recommended a state-wide survey of child-welfare work looking toward the appointment of a children's code commission.

Only one of the eight commission bills presented to the Georgia Legislature, which met June 24, 1925, was enacted. This law, which became effective January 1, 1926, relates to child labor and represents a substantial improvement over previous legal standards. The commission is now at work on measures to be presented to the 1927 legislature.

The New York commission, although without an appropriation, made five recommendations to the legislature, which passed in amended form the measure relating to child marriages.

The Pennsylvania commission continued its studies, in preparation for the 1927 legislative session. The commission cooperated with the Federal Children's Bureau by loaning the services of its executive secretary, who has written the report of the bureau's study of provision for dependent, neglected, and delinquent children in seven Pennsylvania counties.

In South Dakota the child-welfare commission has been actively engaged in promoting county organization for child welfare and is now giving consideration to recommendations to be made to the next legislature. The child-welfare commission has cooperated with the commission for the control and segregation of the feeble-minded in a survey of mentally deficient children in a number of counties.

Two bills drafted by the District of Columbia Commission on Public Welfare Legislation have become law. The first, effective July 1, 1926, establishes a board of public welfare which takes over the functions of three existing boards—the board of charities, the board of children's guardians, and the board of trustees of the National Training School for Girls. The second law provides for public aid to dependent children in their own homes, to be administered by the new Board of Public Welfare. An appropriation of $100,000 is authorized for the first year. A third measure indorsed by the commission, which restores to the juvenile court jurisdiction formerly exercised in nonsupport cases, was also enacted. A commission proposal to revise the whole juvenile court act so as to bring it into harmony with modern ideas and practices has been referred back to it for consideration of certain proposed changes.

The Children's Laws Commission of Rhode Island, organized April 16, 1925, in accordance with an act of the 1925 legislature, recommended to the 1926 legislature 27 bills, of which 22 passed, some in amended form. The five bills that failed to pass all related to child labor.[6]

The Rhode Island bills that became laws greatly improve the legal provision for the dependent, defective, and delinquent children of the State. These laws may be summarized as follows:

1. Creation of a children's bureau in the State public-welfare commission, to promote the enforcement of all laws for the protection of defective, dependent, neglected, wayward, and delinquent children and children born out of wedlock, to cooperate with juvenile and other courts and all reputable child-helping and child-placing agencies of a public or private character, and to take the initiative in all matters involving the interests of such children when adequate legal provision has not already been made.

2. Provision for the licensing and supervision of infants' boarding homes, maternity hospitals, day nurseries, and corporations and agencies doing child-placing and child-caring work, and supervision of child placing. Under one of the laws enacted a parent is prohibited from assigning or otherwise transferring to another not related by blood or marriage his rights or duties with respect to the permanent care and custody of his child under 14 years of age unless duly authorized so to do by an order or decree of court, or unless such assignment is made to a duly authorized or incorporated agency

[6] See p. 26 for laws passed on this subject by Rhode Island in 1926 and p. 27 for those proposed by the commission.

for the care of orphans and needy children. The State public-welfare commission must be notified of all permanent placements in private homes and is required to investigate and supervise such placements. The State commission is also given power to regulate bringing children into or sending them out of the State for the purpose of placing them in foster homes.

3. Extension of the jurisdiction of the juvenile court, which in Rhode Island formerly dealt only with delinquent and wayward children, to include dependent and neglected children. The age limit of 16 years in delinquency cases is retained, but the term "wayward children," who by legal definition constitute a special class in Rhode Island, is extended to include those under the age of 18. The jurisdiction in dependency and neglect cases also extends to the age of 18 years. Provisions regarding binding out of children were repealed.

4. Investigations by the Rhode Island Society for the Prevention of Cruelty to Children or the State public-welfare commission are made mandatory in adoption cases, and a six-months residence in the proposed home before entry of the adoption decree is required, but the courts may waive this requirement for cause shown.

5. The law relating to the State probation officer and probation officers working under his direction was amended, but important features proposed in the bill drafted by the children's laws commission with reference to qualifications of the chief probation officer and method of appointment of his assistants failed to pass. An amendment to the statute providing for probation in juvenile cases was adopted.

6. Amendments to the mothers' aid act place the bureau of mothers' aid directly under the public-welfare commission, instead of making it a division of the State home and school for children, and restrict eligibility for such aid to cases in which the disability arose while there was a domicile in the State.

7. Commitment of poor and indigent minors having no legal settlement within the county to the State home and school instead of to the State infirmary is provided for in another law.

8. Children between the ages of 16 and 18 years habitually spending their time in idleness will be deemed guilty of a misdemeanor under a law passed as a substitute for a commission bill making school attendance compulsory up to the age of 18 years unless the child is regularly and lawfully employed.

9. Amendments were made to the apprenticeship law and the law relating to theatrical performances by children under 16.

10. The father and mother are made joint natural guardians of their minor children equally charged with their care, nurture, welfare, and education under another statute.

11. Three laws relating to children born out of wedlock were passed. One provides that proceedings to establish paternity may be instituted either by a person designated by the State public welfare commission or by a town director of public aid (formerly proceedings were to be instituted only by the latter) and not by the mother. The man adjudged to be the father is liable for the expenses incident to the pregnancy and lying-in of the mother and for the support and education of the child until he reaches the age of 16

years. Legitimation of children by the subsequent marriage of their parents to each other is provided, and the issue of null marriages are made legitimate.

STATE CHILD-WELFARE LEGISLATION, 1926

The legislatures of nine States have met in regular session in 1926—Kentucky, Louisiana, Massachusetts, Mississippi, New Jersey, New York, Rhode Island, South Carolina, and Virginia.

In accordance with its custom the Children's Bureau has received from the States, for the use of its staff and for publication in the Child-Welfare News Summary, information concerning child-welfare legislation proposed and enacted.

Child labor and compulsory school attendance.

Measures relating to standards for the employment of children under 16 are known to have been enacted in Louisiana and in Rhode Island. The Louisiana law, effective July 1, 1927, establishes a maximum 8-hour day and 48-hour week for children under 16, improves the provisions as to the issuance of employment certificates to children going to work, and requires a child to obtain a certificate of physical fitness before receiving an employment certificate. As introduced, the bill would also have required a child to complete the fifth grade before leaving school for work, but this provision was cut out, leaving the law with no educational requirement for working children.

In Rhode Island a law was passed which changes the educational requirements with which a child must comply before leaving school for work from completion of the sixth grade to completion of the eighth grade, with the alternative of eight years' school attendance, requires a child to attend school until 15, even though he has completed the eighth grade (formerly such a child was exempted from school attendance), and weakens the provisions as to special employment permits for mentally defective children and for children working outside school hours and during vacation. Another measure amends the law allowing the appearance of children under 16 in theatrical performances on permit from the mayor or president of the town council by limiting this permission to nonresident children. The latter was a substitute for a bill proposed by the children's laws commission, which would have prohibited such employment for nonresident as well as resident children.

Measures which would to some extent affect the hours of work of minors 16 and over were passed in New York and Virginia. The New York law requires a midway lunch period of at least 20 minutes for factory employees working at least three hours before and three hours after midnight, and the Virginia law includes restaurants in the list of occupations in which the hours for females are limited to 10 per day.

Reports of a number of proposed advances in child-labor and compulsory school attendance standards which failed of enactment into law have been received, but information on this subject is incomplete because of difficulty in obtaining records of bills defeated. In Massachusetts bills which proposed to lengthen the schooling

period by requiring children going to work between 14 and 16 years of age (permitted upon completion of the sixth grade) to attend school half time for 20 weeks each year until 16 years old, and to improve the physical-examination requirement of the law, failed to pass. In New Jersey a bill to raise from completion of the fifth grade to completion of the sixth grade the educational requirement for children between 14 and 16 years of age leaving school for work failed to pass. In New York bills extending the provisions of the night-work prohibition for minor messengers, increasing the number of articles now barred under the labor law from being manufactured in tenement homes and otherwise extending the industrial home work law, and strengthening the law prohibiting children from work in dangerous occupations failed. Measures submitted to the Rhode Island Legislature by the children's laws commission to raise child-labor and school-attendance standards, which failed of enactment, were bills proposing a 9-hour day and 48-hour week for children under 16 (now a 10-hour day and 54-hour week is allowed), lengthening the prohibited night-work period for children under 16, requiring school attendance to 18 years of age of children not legally employed, extending the provisions of the child labor law to work for factories done in homes, and making the street trades law, which now applies only to Providence, state-wide in application. An amendment to the workmen's compensation law requiring payment of double compensation in the case of minors injured while illegally employed also failed in Rhode Island. The Virginia Legislature failed to pass a bill to extend the application of the compulsory school attendance law to children between 7 and 16 years of age (now between 8 and 14 years of age). Attempts to raise standards as to hours of labor for females, which would have affected the work of minor girls, failed in New York and in New Jersey.

From some States unsuccessful attempts to lower existing standards are reported. In New York bills were introduced to lower the age for required attendance at continuation schools and to permit attendance at night instead of in the daytime. Bills introduced in New York to permit the employment of females at night and in Massachusetts to increase their hours of labor would have affected the work of minor girls. In Virginia a proposal to lower for certain occupations the age standard of the child labor law, and in New York a measure to permit the employment of boys 12 years of age in mercantile and many other occupations outside school hours, without employment certificates, and to make the prohibited night-work period for all children under 16 in these occupations begin at 8 p. m. instead of 6 p. m., failed of adoption.

Maternity and infancy and child hygiene.

In order to meet a situation created by a decision of the court that the model vital statistics law is unconstitutional in Georgia, the legislature in special session voted to submit to the people a constitutional amendment to legalize the payment of registrars out of county funds for the gathering of vital statistics. New Jersey increased the bond issues authorized for first-class counties to acquire lands and erect buildings to be used as maternity hospitals. The Rhode Island laws sponsored by the commission on children's

laws, relating to the licensing and supervision of maternity hospitals, day nurseries, and infant boarding homes, have already been mentioned. (See p. 24.) In addition, laws were passed strengthening the enforcement provision of the act regarding the registration of births, deaths, and marriages, and relating to the grading and sale of milk.

Louisiana amended the existing law regulating the practice of nursing. Kentucky authorized fiscal courts in counties containing cities of the second class to establish and maintain clinics for the use and benefit of indigent school children. Mississippi amended the law providing for the abolishment of local health agencies upon the creation of county or district health departments, giving such departments additional authority and permitting municipal appropriations for the support thereof.

In New York an appropriation of $59,387.98 was made for the payment of State aid to counties engaging in public-health projects approved by the commissioner of health. New York also passed a measure designed to remove objections that had been made to the establishment of county health departments. It provides a method of abolishing such departments at any time beyond two years after their establishment, and specifies that the compensation of the county health officer shall be within the limits of the appropriation made for the salaries of the employees of the district board of health.

New Jersey has created a temporary State commission to inquire into and report upon the number, distribution, and condition of crippled children in the State and to make provision for promoting the care, education, treatment, and general welfare of such children. The commission is to consist of seven members, and it is directed to report, with recommendations, to the legislature of 1927.

New York, in continuing its work for crippled children, increased the appropriation to $75,000, $20,000 of which goes to the State department of health and $5,000 to the State department of education. The remaining $50,000 is to be used as a fund from which both the State commissioner of health and the State commissioner of education may draw to refund to local communities one-half of the amount expended by them for special medical, surgical, therapeutic treatments or appliances, and for special education and transportation.

Dependent, defective, and delinquent children.

As part of the reorganization of the State departments pursuant to a constitutional amendment, New York has transferred certain additional functions to the department of charities and has established within the department three divisions, a division of visitation and inspection, a division of administration of institutions, and a division of special welfare interests.

The legislation relating to dependent children, sponsored by the Rhode Island Children's Laws Commission, has already been summarized. (See p. 24.)

Louisiana passed an act authorizing police juries to enter into annual contract with legally authorized children's foundling societies for the care and placing of delinquent, neglected, or abandoned children in homes within the State of Louisiana. New Jersey has

amended the legal-settlement provisions of the mothers' pension act and has increased from $4 to $6 the amount that a county may pay for the maintenance of children under 18 years of age in duly incorporated charitable institutions.

Louisiana passed a law making it a misdemeanor for a male person over the age of 18 to take indecent liberties with a female child under the age of 14. New Jersey has made mandatory a five-year minimum sentence for violation of the age-of-consent law. New York has made the employment in the drug traffic of any child actually or apparently under the age of 16 years a felony with a sentence of from 2½ to 5 years' imprisonment.

Louisiana provided for the creation and maintenance of a State industrial school for delinquent, dependent, and neglected girls 7 to 21 years of age, and amended the existing law providing for the State reform school for boys. South Carolina prohibited the confinement of any child under the age of 12 years in a reformatory or industrial school.

Kentucky increased the salaries of probation officers in counties having a city of the first class. The salary of the juvenile-court judge in New Jersey counties of the first class has been raised from $6,000 per year to $9,000 per year. The Erie County (N. Y.) court of domestic relations has been given jurisdiction over illegitimacy cases in the city of Buffalo as well as in the county. The juvenile-court legislation of Rhode Island has already been mentioned. (See p. 25.) A special domestic-relations court commission was created by the legislature in Rhode Island to prepare a draft of such legislation as shall be necessary for the establishment of a court of domestic relations.

Virginia has authorized the establishment of separate departments for idiots at the State colonies for the feeble-minded. Formerly the reception of idiots in such colonies was prohibited.

Guardianship and marriage.

The father and mother have been given equal rights to the services and earnings of their minor children in New Jersey. The Rhode Island guardianship law has already been mentioned. (See p. 25.)

The marriage license law of New Jersey has been amended to require the contracting parties to take oath as to the truth of the facts regarding the legality of the proposed marriage, verified by a witness, and to provide that no license may be issued until after 48 hours have elapsed from the time of application. New York has prohibited the marriage of boys under 16 and of girls under 14 years of age, provided a penalty for the illegal issuance of a license to children under those ages, and limited the officials who may perform the marriage of girls between the ages of 14 and 16 years.

Recreation.

Louisiana passed a law regulating public dance halls, cabarets, and places where public dances are held.

Massachusetts passed a law authorizing cities and towns by ordinance or by law to regulate within their respective limits entertainments, dances, and other diversions and amusements, not required by

law to be licensed, including the hours of holding the same. It also passed an act requiring the licensing of keepers of inns and restaurants and other establishments conducting certain amusements, including dances, in connection with their business.

Virginia has passed an act for the regulation of public dance halls in any county adjoining a city of 50,000 inhabitants or more.

Rhode Island has amended its law relating to the licensing of public amusements by permitting motion-picture exhibitions on Sunday in certain cities.

CHILD WELFARE IN OTHER COUNTRIES

The bureau has continued its efforts to keep in touch with child-welfare movements in other countries, particularly those in the Western Hemisphere. The Fifth Pan American Child Congress, to be held in Habana in 1927, will, it is hoped, greatly increase the exchange of ideas and results of work undertaken by both public and private agencies in North and South America.

As an outgrowth of the first four child congresses an International American Institute for the Protection of Childhood has been established in Montevideo, Uruguay. This institute is intended to serve as a center for the exchange of information between meetings of the congress. An international board consisting of a delegate from each adhering country appointed by his Government will be the governing body of the institute. The annual membership fee to be paid by each Government adhering is $2,000. By action of Congress the United States is a member of a number of international organizations with somewhat similar purposes; for example, the International Institute of Agriculture, the International Office of Public Health, the International Research Council, the International Prison Commission, and the Pan American Sanitary Bureau. It is therefore to be hoped that Congress will make possible the active cooperation of the United States with this organization for the promotion of child welfare in the Western Hemisphere.

Correspondence and personal contacts with representatives of South American and Central American countries indicate increasing interest in the development of the professions of social work and public-health nursing. In several countries beginnings have been made in the establishment of schools training for these professions. The Second Pan American Red Cross Conference, held in Washington in May, 1926, gave special attention to the subject of child welfare. Resolutions were adopted dealing with the protection of maternity and infancy, health of school children, health teaching and popular health education, nutrition, and related topics.

While the Chief of the Children's Bureau was prevented by the pressure of official business in Washington from attending in a consultative capacity the 1926 meeting of the advisory commission on the welfare of children and young persons of the League of Nations, cooperation with the commission has continued. At the request of the committee on child welfare of the commission a report analyzing the State motion picture censorship laws which have been

enacted in seven States and regulations attempted in cities having a population of 100,000 and over, and describing the unofficial censorship exercised by the National Board of Review and the various efforts that have been made to stimulate the production of good pictures and the demand for such pictures by the public, was prepared by the bureau for the 1926 meeting of the committee. It is believed that the usefulness of this committee has been greatly increased by the decision on the part of the council of the league to add to the assessors serving with the official members of the committees—heretofore all European—representatives of the National Conference of Social Work of the United States, the Canadian Child Welfare Council, and the Pan American Child Congress.

EXHIBITS

Some expansion of the Children's Bureau work in exhibits occurred during the year. New material has been added, and wider use has been made of old material. A film on posture was completed in March, 1926. Since that date the bureau has received approximately 500 requests for the loan of the film. Posture charts also were produced, approximately 900 of which have been distributed free by the bureau to physicians, clinics, health organizations, schools, and other responsible officials and groups, and 1,000 sets have been sold by the Government Printing Office since their delivery about March 1.

Several film-slide projectors that utilize films in the showing of still pictures have been purchased, and strips of film illustrating various phases of child welfare have been made up by the bureau. The subjects covered include the care of the baby, rickets, maternity and infancy work, juvenile delinquency, and vocational guidance. Other strips are in preparation.

Special sets of posters have been made up in the exhibits section, and other posters have been purchased to add to the bureau's loan collection.

The Sesquicentennial exhibit.

A special appropriation of $10,000 has enabled the Children's Bureau to participate in the Government exhibit at the Sesquicentennial Exposition in Philadelphia. The main features of the bureau's exhibit include: A children's clinic in active operation, a model nursery, a model playground, a baby "fashion show," and moving pictures and film slides on the various phases of child welfare.

Dominating the whole and striking the keynote of the exhibit and of the work of the Children's Bureau is the great mural 18 by 7 feet, entitled "The Child Shall Be First." In the foreground of this painting America is shown as a tall and beautiful mother in a blossoming orchard, with a child on her shoulder and little children playing in the protection of her presence.

PUBLICATIONS

During the fiscal year 1926, 27 new and revised publications were issued. Twenty others are now in press and 31 in preparation.

Reports issued during the fiscal year ended June 30, 1926:

Thirteenth Annual Report of the Chief, Children's Bureau, 1925.
The Promotion of the Welfare and Hygiene of Maternity and Infancy—The Administration of the Act of Congress of November 23, 1921, Fiscal Year Ended June 30, 1924. No. 146.
Standards of Prenatal Care; an outline for the use of physicians. No. 153.
Child Management, by D. A. Thom, M. D. (revised October, 1925). No. 143.
Standards for Physicians Conducting Conferences in Child-Health Centers. No. 154.
Child Labor in Fruit and Hop Growing Districts of the Northern Pacific Coast, by Alice Channing. No. 151.
Child Labor in Representative Tobacco-Growing Areas, by Harriet A. Byrne. No. 155.
Industrial Accidents to Employed Minors in Wisconsin, Massachusetts, and New Jersey, by Edith S. Gray. No. 152.
References on Child Labor and Minors in Industry, 1916–1924, by Laura A. Thompson. No. 147.
Vocational Guidance and Junior Placement; 12 cities in the United States, prepared by the Industrial Division of the Children's Bureau and the Junior Division of the United States Employment Service. No. 149.
Adoption Laws in the United States; a summary of the development of adoption legislation and significant features of adoption statutes, with the text of selected laws, by Emelyn Foster Peck. No. 148.
Children Indentured by the Wisconsin State Public School. No. 150.
Foster-Home Care for Dependent Children (revised). No. 136.
Juvenile-Court Statistics; a tentative plan for uniform reporting of statistics of delinquency, dependency, and neglect. No. 159.
Laws Relating to Sex Offenses against Children, by Reuben Oppenheimer and Lulu L. Eckman. No. 145.

Charts, dodgers, folders, and leaflets issued during the fiscal year ended June 30, 1926:

Causes and Prevention of Antenatal, Intranatal, and Neonatal Deaths. (Reprinted from Transactions of the Second Annual Meeting, October, 1924, American Child Health Association.)
The Control of Rickets; a preliminary discussion of the demonstration in New Haven. (Reprinted from the Journal of the American Medical Association, August 29, 1925, Vol. 85, pp. 656–661.)
Disobedience, Lying, and Stealing. (Reprinted from Pub. No. 143, Child Management, revised.)
Posture Standards (six charts).
Sunlight for Babies.
Children in Street Trades in the United States; a list of references. (Reprinted from December, 1925, Monthly Labor Review.)
Case Work with Unmarried Parents and Their Children. (Reprinted from Hospital Social Service, XII, 1926, 69.)
Psychoclinical Guidance in Child Adoption, by Arnold Gesell, M. D. (Reprinted from No. 136, Foster-Home Care for Dependent Children, revised.)
What Builds Babies? The Mother's Diet in the Pregnant and Nursing Periods. Folder No. 4.
Is Your Child's Birth Recorded? (Revised April 1, 1926.)
Ground Plan for City Playground.
The Health of the Child Is the Power of the Nation (two posters).

Reports in press at close of fiscal year ended June 30, 1926:

Maternal Mortality; the risk of death in childbirth and from all diseases caused by pregnancy and confinement, by Robert Morse Woodbury, Ph. D.[7]
The Promotion of the Welfare and Hygiene of Maternity and Infancy—The Administration of the Act of Congress of November 23, 1921, Fiscal Year Ended June 30, 1925.
Proceedings of the Third Annual Conference of State Directors in Charge of the Local Administration of the Maternity and Infancy Act of November 23, 1921.
Milk, the Indispensable Food for Children, by Dorothy Reed Mendenhall, M. D., revised edition.
A Study of Maternity Homes in Pennsylvania and Minnesota.
Posture Clinics; organization and exercises, by Armin Klein, M. D.
Posture Exercises; a handbook for schools and for teachers of physical education, by Armin Klein, M. D., and Leah C. Thomas.
References on the Growth and Development of the Normal Child.
Sunlight for Babies. Folder No. 5.[7]
From School to Work. Folder No. 6.
Breast Feeding. Folder No. 8.
Baby's Daily Time Cards (six charts).
Work of Children on Illinois Farms, by Dorothy M. Williams and Mary E. Skinner.
Public Aid to Mothers with Dependent Children; extent and fundamental principles, by Emma O. Lundberg.
Community Care of Dependent, Delinquent, and Handicapped Children. Folder No. 7.
Dependent and Delinquent Children in Georgia; a study of the prevalence and treatment of child dependency and delinquency in 30 counties with special reference to legal protection needed.
Dependent and Delinquent Children in North Dakota and South Dakota; a study of the prevalence, treatment, and prevention of child dependency and delinquency in two rural States.
Handbook for the Use of Boards of Directors, Superintendents, and Staffs of Institutions for Dependent Children.
Work of Child-Placing Agencies. Part I—A Social Study of Ten Agencies Caring for Dependent Children, by Katharine P. Hewins and L. Josephine Webster. Part II—Health Supervision of Children Placed in Foster Homes, by Mary S. Evans, M. D.
Recreation for Blind Children, by Martha Travilla Speakman.

Reports in preparation at close of fiscal year ended June 30, 1926:

Fourteenth Annual Report of the Chief, Children's Bureau, 1926.
The Promotion of the Welfare and Hygiene of Maternity and Infancy—The Administration of the Act of Congress of November 23, 1921, Fiscal Year Ended June 30, 1926.
Relation of Posture to Physical Fitness.
Study of Rickets in Children in Washington, D. C.
What Is Malnutrition?
Administration of Laws Exempting Children from School Attendance to Work at Home.
Child Labor and Vocational Opportunities for Minors in New Jersey.
Child Labor in Canneries.
Child-Labor Legislation in the United States: Part 1—Text of Laws; Part 2—Analysis.
Children in Street Trades.
Current Statistics as to Legally Employed Children.
The Minimum Wage and the Child Worker.
Vocational Opportunities for Minors in the Printing Trades, New York City.
Vocational Opportunities for Minors in the Clothing Trades, New York City.
Vocational Opportunities for Minors in Milwaukee.

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[7] Issued in July, 1926.

Work Opportunities for Minors of Subnormal Mentality, Part 1.
Work Opportunities for Minors of Subnormal Mentality, Part 2.
Child Dependency in the United States.
The Child, the Family, and the Court.
Child-Welfare Conditions and Resources of Seven Pennsylvania Counties.
Child Welfare in New Jersey; the State's provision for dependent and delinquent children.
Children of Illegitimate Birth and Measures for Their Protection.
Children of Illegitimate Birth Who Have Been Reared by Relatives.
The Children's Bureau of Cleveland; a study in community care of dependent children.
The County as a Unit for an Organized Program of Social Work.
Health, Housing, Education, and Recreation Standards in Public Aid to Children in Their Own Homes.
Indenture of Dependent Children.
Juvenile Delinquency in Boston.
Public Child-Caring Work in Certain Counties of Minnesota, North Carolina, and New York.
Study of Case Work for Delinquent Girls.
State Provision for Crippled Children.

DISTRIBUTION OF PUBLICATIONS

During the past year the bureau distributed 1,687,181 publications, including folders, dodgers, and popular bulletins. This figure is a considerable increase over the last year owing to two facts: (1) Congress made available an additional sum of $7,500 for the child-care series, and (2) several very brief and inexpensive bulletins were printed for the maternity and infant-hygiene division and distributed to the number of approximately 300,000, the distribution of the more expensive reports being curtailed in order to make this possible and publication of some reports being postponed until 1927. More than 200,000 of the dodgers and leaflets previously issued were distributed in 1926. Of the popular bulletins in the child-care series the number distributed were as follows: Infant Care, 311,142; Prenatal Care, 170,956; Child Care, 165,511; Child Management, 72,490; Sunlight for Babies, 22,898. The sales of the first four of these as reported by the Superintendent of Documents amounted to 185,000 in 1926. Of the reports of bureau investigations, legal research, etc., approximately 150,000 copies were distributed. The bureau is never able to meet the demand for its various publications. It has used every precaution to prevent wasteful or unrewarding distribution. It has endeavored to stimulate the purchase of bulletins during the past four years and has succeeded, but the problem still remains how to make the present printing fund meet the needs. It is, obviously, not economical but wasteful to collect material which is not made available to the public or to curtail the free distribution of publications which will aid materially in the reduction of death and sickness among children. The bureau will be compelled to do both these things during 1927.

In addition to information supplied through publications, the bureau replies to many letters requesting advice. Last year 107,508 letters were received by the bureau.

The Child-Welfare News Summary was issued 30 times during the year. The summary is sent on request only, to persons who are actively engaged in child-welfare work and to child-welfare agencies and publications.

The World's Children, which is a single mimeographed page of items of special news interest compiled from the News Summary, was issued 16 times. This is sent on request to a mailing list which now numbers 1,125. The items are frequently republished, sometimes singly and sometimes as a special section on child welfare, in a number of magazines and newspapers.

GENERAL DEVELOPMENT OF THE WORK OF THE BUREAU

For the past four years the bureau's appropriation has been decreased, and a further decrease for 1927 will require further curtailment of bureau activities and important opportunities for service to children will again be lost. Each year the bureau refuses more requests for help in investigations and for consultation on local problems which come from both public and private agencies than it accepts. In addition to being enabled to meet an increasing number of these demands from year to year, it is recommended that a division on delinquency be created to conduct research in the field of prevention and proper care of delinquents and on request to confer with local agencies on these problems.

The present concern over crime and criminal tendencies in the United States makes the creation of this division especially important at this time. Crime begins in delinquency among children. Though the sensational statements about increase in crime are not justified by the evidence available, no one would deny that the facts justify the demand for scientific study of methods of prevention. The requests which come to the Children's Bureau for research in this field and for consultation with local agencies can not be met with the present appropriation. This very important subject of juvenile delinquency is one of several subjects assigned to the social-service division of the Children's Bureau, whose field of work also includes dependent, neglected, and handicapped children. To meet the present need a division devoted entirely to this subject and having the necessary social investigators, psychiatrists, and psychologists should be created. This would require an additional annual appropriation of approximately $50,000. Such an expenditure would be in the interest of national economy. At present we pay too much for the care and punishment of criminals and too little for the prevention of crime. Scientific research is the foundation on which a program of prevention must be built.

Respectfully submitted.

GRACE ABBOTT, *Chief.*

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